

Author: Andrea Sonnenberg

Balancing Acts: Ethical Challenges in the TikTok-YouTube Remix Culture

Abstract:

In today's digital environment, platforms like TikTok and YouTube have revolutionized content creation and consumption, offering creators unparalleled reach and engagement. These platforms have levelled the content creation field, allowing individuals from diverse backgrounds to showcase their talents and creativity to a global audience. The most significant shift has been that the people formerly known as the audience went from consumers to prosumers. However, this transformation has produced ethical and legal challenges, from half-truths about user rights to false copyright claims on YouTube, especially those related to content creators cross-posting TikTok Stitches and Duets. This paper will discuss ethical dilemmas content creators face due to platform policies, the impact of false copyright claims on creators' livelihoods, and the broader implications for intellectual property rights in the digital age. Through a comprehensive review of relevant literature, legal frameworks, and case studies, this paper aims to provide insights into the complexities of user rights on social media platforms in North America and propose strategies to protect creators' rights and encourage ethical content practices.

Agenda:

Introduction.....	2
User Protection on TikTok.....	3
The Case of Content Creator DrKojoSarfo.....	4
Copyright Infringement Claims.....	5
The Ambiguous Policies of TikTok and YouTube.....	6
Misguided Knowledge of Users Intellectual Property Rights.....	8
Legal Frameworks of Social Media Platforms.....	9
Ethical Practices Essential For Content Creators and Consumers.....	10
Issues with YouTube's Accountability In False Copyright Infringement Claims.....	11
Proposals for Protecting Social Media User's Rights.....	12
Conclusion.....	13

Introduction

TikTok is a popular social media platform where users can watch, create, and share short-form videos from 15 seconds to 15 minutes. It has a wide range of camera filters, sound effects, and access to copyrighted music. Other features on TikTok involve how content creators interact with other creators' videos, mainly remixes. These include Duets, which TikTok pioneered, and Stitches. Duets are created when content creators tap the "Duet" button while watching a video they want to collaborate with. This then opens up the duet creation screen, which is a split screen, where the original video is on one side of the screen, and the 'reacting' creator is on the other. Duets often lead to trends and challenges as users build on each other's ideas and create new forms of entertainment within TikTok. Stitches are made similar to Duets, where a 'reacting' creator taps on the "Stitch" button while watching a video they want to use as the starting point for their Stitch. This feature allows creators to use up to 5 seconds of the selected video before transitioning into their content. Stitches are typically utilized to create response videos, expand on ideas, or collaboratively contribute to ongoing trends and challenges.

Other social media platforms soon realized that TikTok was staying current on user needs and creating a new culture surrounding an app dedicated to 15-second videos. This is particularly prevalent in North America as it is considered a "mass audience."¹ User-generated content is constantly changing, and how users and creators interact with this content is evolving as well due to added features in video-sharing apps. With TikTok's growing popularity, YouTube, a video-sharing platform, was slowly fading on people's radar as their content was long-form. To keep up with TikTok, YouTube created YouTube Shorts in 2021. YouTube Shorts are short-form videos that can be up to 60 seconds long. YouTube became a part of the short-form game and allowed users to cross-post content from any social media platform, including YouTube itself, TikTok, Instagram, and others. When creators cross-post, they post the same videos across multiple social media platforms to reach a wider audience. With the added YouTube Shorts, content creators can also gain a more significant income through the YouTube Partner Program than they would from other platforms since YouTube is known as a money-making platform. YouTube rewards

¹ Corinne M. Dalelio, *Interactive Media and Society*, (Lexington Books, 2022), 63.

content creators handsomely for bringing in user traffic. However, cross-posting is now becoming an issue because the creators of the remixed content believe their work has been used without due credit. Even though TikTok policies state that creators give full permission for others to remix their content², the original content creators are filing YouTube copyright strike claims.

User Protection on TikTok

For TikTok, both Duets and Stitches create interest and make users stop instead of scrolling past. There is a significant concern and misunderstanding about user rights; however, creators have some protection regarding their content. On TikTok, users can delete videos that use their content in Duets and Stitches. They are also able to turn off other creators' ability to Stitch and Duet their videos, even while having a public account.³ However, this is not enough to truly protect the intellectual property rights of users of TikTok's services. Though, as previously mentioned, TikTok is not the only short-form video platform out there, other platforms like Instagram already had video sharing incorporated years before TikTok officially launched in the United States in 2017. What is remarkable about TikTok is that "[s]ince its initial days as a lip-syncing app (initially known as Musical.ly) in 2016, TikTok has established itself as a global heavy hitter in the social media platform market."⁴ It monopolized cultural norms and trends surrounding it⁵ at a remarkable rate, specifically between 2019 and 2021, when the world was coping with the coronavirus pandemic.

² Susan Abramovitch, Madison MacColl, and Esther Kim, "TikTok: Time to Think About Copyright," *Gowling WLG*, September 27, 2022.

<https://gowlingwlg.com/en/insights-resources/articles/2022/tiktok-time-to-think-about-copyright/>.

"Although TikTok's Terms of Service ("ToS") explicitly prohibit copyright infringement and require users to acknowledge that they own the copyright in their original uploaded content, it also encourages users to create and collaborate. The ToS provide that by uploading content to the platform, a user is granting TikTok an unconditional irrevocable, non-exclusive, royalty-free licence, which, among other things, allows other users to modify, adapt, reproduce and make derivative works of the content. This grant is only valid if the user actually owned the copyright. If not, you may be liable for indirect copyright infringement and could have your content taken down."

³ "Stitch," TikTok, accessed April 13, 2024, <https://support.tiktok.com/en/using-tiktok/creating-videos/stitch>.

⁴ Danica Facca, Arun Jacob, J. P. King, Mujgan Ozceylan, and Sara Grimes, *Academic*

TikTok Report, (Knowledge Media Design Institution (KMDI), August 2022), https://tspace.library.utoronto.ca/bitstream/1807/124170/1/Academic_TikTok_Report_KMDI_2022.pdf.

⁵ Facca et al.

The Case of Content Creator DrKojoSarfo

With an expanded digital environment caused by the coronavirus pandemic, rules and regulations regarding user-generated content also shifted exponentially, as did the need for a more significant income in an economy stuck in a downward spiral. Capitalism tends to work its way into every aspect of the economy, including income from original content. Central to navigating false copyright claims on YouTube lies a narrow understanding of legal frameworks, like fair use. Fair use provisions allow for using copyrighted material for commentary, criticism, parody, and news reporting, all without explicit permission. However, applying fair use principles in digital environments requires carefully considering the copyrighted work's transformative use, impact, and nature. These principles create challenges in content moderation and dispute resolution on platforms. Consider the case of content creator DrKojoSarfo, whose experience highlights the challenges creators face with false copyright claims. DrKojoSarfo faced copyright claims on YouTube for using stitched and dueted content created on TikTok and cross-posted onto YouTube. Despite falling under fair use provisions, his content was subjected to demands for monetization by third parties, leading to financial losses and ethical dilemmas. Unlike YouTube, a big moneymaker for creators, TikTok does not pay for duets or stitches and offers a small amount of money per one million views. While it is unfair that only DrKojoSarfo can profit from these remixed videos, sharing and transforming short-form videos for years has become a cultural norm. Giving credit is not enough anymore because capitalism creates antagonism between digital creators.

Copyright laws are the foundation for protecting creators' intellectual property rights, granting them exclusive rights to reproduce, distribute, and display their works. False copyright claims occur when individuals or entities assert ownership over content without legitimate rights or misuse copyright enforcement mechanisms for defamation of another individual, as seen with DrKojoSarfo, who received mixed reactions when he announced on February 11, 2024, that he would not continue to create and post Stitches and Duets for the time being. However, both sides agreed it would be best to stop creating remixed videos, and discussions of his popularity as a black content creator were prevalent. To combat the copyright claims against his content on YouTube, he continuously submitted copyright removal

requests⁶ to keep his YouTube account active, as three strikes in 90 days permanently deleted a user's YouTube account⁷. DrKojoSarfo is one of many content creators who have dealt with the pressing dilemma surrounding false copyright claims. However, even if these creators are using copyrighted material, "[t]he fact that copyright infringement is so frequently committed via interactive media makes copyright rules very difficult to enforce."⁸

Copyright Infringement Claims

Content creators, especially those cross-posting TikTok Stitches and Duets onto their YouTube channels, often find themselves caught in legal battles and monetization disputes due to ambiguous platform policies and automated copyright enforcement mechanisms⁹. The consequences of these claims go beyond financial losses, affecting creators' ability to engage with their audiences and stifling creative expression. However, even if these claims are found unsubstantiated, YouTube will not do anything to prosecute the individuals who filed the false claim, even if it causes defamation for the one given the copyright claim. The only defamation cases they will take on are videos that harass another individual.¹⁰ Edward Lee's article, "Warming up to User-Generated Content," explores the challenges creators faced in 2008 when navigating copyright rules, particularly in social sharing and economic motivations. While copyright rules may seem up in the air now, digital creators were genuinely living in the Wild West in the late-2000s to mid-2010s. Even in 2008, there was a dire need for copyright rules to align with the evolving norms of content creation and sharing on the internet.¹¹ As informal norms and online sharing

⁶ "Submit a copyright removal request," YouTube Help, accessed April 13, 2024, <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/2807622?hl=en>.

⁷ "Community Guidelines strike basics on YouTube," YouTube Help, accessed April 16, 2024, <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/2802032>.

⁸ Dalelio, 66.

⁹ Lindsay Dodgson, "YouTubers' Channels Are Being Held Hostage With Fake Copyright Claims," *Business Insider*, last modified June 2, 2022, <https://www.businessinsider.com/youtubers-channels-are-being-held-hostage-with-fake-copyright-claims-2020-6>.

¹⁰ "Defamation," Youtube Help, accessed April 13, 2024, https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/6154230?hl=en&ref_topic=6154211.

¹¹ Edward, Lee. "Warming Up To User-Generated Content." *University Of Illinois Law Review* 2008, no. 5 (August 31, 2008) <https://illinoislawreview.org/print/volume-2008-issue-5/warming-up-to-user-generated-content/>.

practices completely diverged from traditional copyright concepts, the legitimacy of copyright law itself has come into question.

The Ambiguous Policies of TikTok and YouTube

A significant issue among social media platform users, especially those in North America, is a need for more awareness of their rights. Perhaps "...ethics can play a mediating role between morality and the law.¹²" However, due to the lack of user knowledge regarding content ownership, copyright, fair use, and direct intellectual property infringement, the question of ethics gets thrown out the window. Almost every person skips right past every app and website's Terms of Service/Service agreements. Most of these agreements discuss the gathering and selling user data, the privacy of user's personal information, and users' rights. However, both TikTok's and YouTube's Terms of Service are neverending spider webs that either lead a person in circles, into dead ends, or right back to where they started without answering anything fully. However, it should be noted that some personal rights and community guidelines are very straightforward. First, by utilizing TikTok's services, users forfeit all moral rights. In the 'User-Generated Content' section, the Terms of Service states:

To the extent any moral rights are not transferable or assignable, you hereby waive and agree never to assert any and all moral rights, or to support, maintain or permit any action based on any moral rights that you may have in or with respect to any User Content you post to or through the Services.¹³

Another legal framework that users unknowingly agree to is that social media platforms, like YouTube and TikTok, own user-generated content as it is stored on their servers. Both YouTube and TikTok's Terms of Service state that by using these services, users are granting "worldwide, non-exclusive, royalty-free, sublicensable and transferable license to use that Content (including to reproduce, distribute, prepare

¹² Richard J. Severson, *The Principles of Information Ethics*, (M.E. Sharpe, 1997), 53.

¹³ Sage Smith, "Being conscientious when consuming and producing TikTok content," *Iowa State Daily*, March 10, 2020, <https://iowastatedaily.com/240079/news/being-conscientious-when-consuming-and-producing-tiktok-content/>.

derivative works, display and perform it) in connection with the Service...”¹⁴ Both TikTok¹⁵ and YouTube also states that even if there is a complaint between two users, both platforms have the right to decide whether or not their company intervenes “[e]xcept as required by applicable law...”¹⁶ Yet, on the community guidelines and policy pages, which are the easiest to access, both platforms come off as wanting everyone to have a good time and be safe while uploading, remixing, sharing, commenting, and knowing their rights as creators, all of which is incredibly laughable after reading the legalese.

The Terms of Service and the Community Guidelines are like night and day. Even though there have been ethical advances in corporations, they are not following those ethical policies and “morality is not responding effectively to the prescriptive and often confusing legal constraints concerning intellectual property.”¹⁷ These platforms also give users half-truths of user rights regarding the protection and usage of user-generated content. However, TikTok is very upfront about content creators with public profiles giving explicit permission for others to Duet and Stitch their videos unless the original poster turns this off. Even if users cannot follow the numerous community guidelines and policy pages, a simple browser search can tell digital creators of the rights and permissions they give away by agreeing to the Terms and Conditions. Many users are not worried about giving up their right to content, such as Ellasandra Muse, who continues to stay on TikTok “...because she finds it entertaining.”¹⁸

Misguided Knowledge of Users' Intellectual Property Rights

Even with policies and community guidelines of social media platforms being readily available, users must understand that intellectual property rights of content created outside these platforms differ from content

¹⁴ “Terms of Service,” YouTube, accessed April 13, 2024, <https://www.youtube.com/static?gl=CA&template=terms>.

¹⁵ “Terms of Service,” TikTok, accessed April 13, 2024, <https://www.tiktok.com/legal/page/row/terms-of-service/en>.

“You or the owner of your User Content still own the copyright in User Content sent to us, but by submitting User Content via the Services, you hereby grant us an unconditional irrevocable, non-exclusive, royalty-free, fully transferable, perpetual worldwide licence to use, modify, adapt, reproduce, make derivative works of, publish and/or transmit, and/or distribute and to authorise other users of the Services and other third-parties to view, access, use, download, modify, adapt, reproduce, make derivative works of, publish and/or transmit your User Content in any format and on any platform, either now known or hereinafter invented.”

¹⁶ “Terms of Service,” TikTok.

¹⁷ Severson, 35.

¹⁸ Smith.

created using TikTok and YouTube services. Regarding copyright issues of content made outside of YouTube and then shared using the platform, YouTube has systems such as Content ID. Content ID is supposed to let the creator know they are using copyrighted material and choose between options like allowing the owner to monetize off the video or muting or deleting the video.¹⁹ However, if the creator has permission to use the content, like Stitches and Duets, it is covered under fair use. As mentioned, remixes allow only a tiny section of the original content to be used (5-15 seconds), compelling the content to be transformed and fall under fair use policies.

The only creators with complete intellectual property rights create anything outside social media, such as music, films, and novels, and then post that content to gain traffic. However, this content does still find its way onto these platforms even though they "...*should* have first obtained permission from the owners to do so; merely giving a credit attribution does not suffice."²⁰ Also, content shared from private accounts without permission or knowledge of the account holder is a clear violation of both social media content-sharing policies and privacy policies. It also violates the many spoken rules and unspoken norms of social media. One spoken rule, thought of as social media etiquette, is to give credit where it's due. It is an essential social code within content creation. It is also vital outside content creation as it is a simplified version of providing a bibliography or references. External to the small world of TikTok and YouTube, the integrity of a creator is an essential moral code. On the other hand, one unspoken cultural norm created through the global expansion of short-form videos is to jump on the bandwagon quickly when a TikTok trend spreads across the platform like wildfire. Highly engaging trends are a way for content creators, especially those just starting, to gain traction and traffic, even if the originator of the trend is never appropriately credited.

¹⁹ "Information Ethics and Youtube Copyright Infringement System", *The Information Age*, last modified on October 14, 2017, <https://katjameden.wordpress.com/2017/10/14/information-ethics-and-youtube-copyright-infringement-system/#more-126>.

²⁰ Dalelio, 66.

Legal Frameworks of Social Media Platforms

The legal landscape surrounding copyright enforcement on social media platforms is complex, with platforms like YouTube and TikTok navigating between creator rights, fair use doctrines, and compliance with copyright laws. While platforms have automated tools such as Content ID on YouTube to detect copyrighted material, false positives and misuse of copyright claims remain significant issues.²¹ Platforms are responsible for establishing transparent copyright policies, ensuring fair use protections, and providing avenues for creators to dispute false claims effectively. However, the balance between protecting creators' rights and addressing copyright infringement claims has significant challenges, often resulting in creators facing unfavourable consequences due to platform policies. Most of these internet giants like Google (YouTube) "...that claim they have our best interests at heart and feed us information...are the same organizations that are keeping us in the dark."²² While YouTube and TikTok navigate this mess, as mentioned before, many content creators are unaware of the difference between fair use and consent regarding their TikTok videos.

Lauren Levinson discusses similar issues in her law comment, *Adapting Fair Use to Reflect Social Media Norms: A Joint Proposal*, featured in the UCLA Law Review. She utilizes examples from Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and others to describe cases of copyright infringements with a defence of fair use. Unfortunately, people are not educated enough in intellectual property laws and policies, are confusing public dialogue with the public domain, and are not familiarizing themselves with social media platforms' operating policies.²³ They are having issues with content creators who want to control how their content is distributed, leading to increased copyright infringement suits. While users of this content use fair use as their defence, fair use only works under certain circumstances; it's all about how the user transformed the original content. While this Comment is a wealth of knowledge, it was made in 2017, which means it has no information on TikTok, as TikTok was not globally available until 2018. However, it provides a good

²¹ "Terms of Service," YouTube: "We may use automated systems that analyze your Content to help detect infringement and abuse, such as spam, malware, and illegal content."

²² "Information Ethics and Youtube Copyright Infringement System."

²³ Lauren Levinson, "Adapting Fair Use to Reflect Social Media Norms: A Joint Proposal," *UCLA Law Review* 64, no. 4 (2017) <https://www.uclalawreview.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/09/Levinson-64-4.pdf>.

reference point for where the world was when the “age of the influencer” started to become a career for all age groups.

Ethical Practices Essential For Content Creators and Consumers

Beyond legal frameworks, implementing ethical content creation practices requires a collaborative effort involving creators, platforms, and users. Educating content creators about copyright laws, fair use principles, and platform guidelines is crucial in promoting responsible content creation and sharing. Community norms play a vital role in shaping ethical practices discouraging actions such as defamation, extortion, and misuse of copyright claims. Platforms must prioritize user education, transparent policies, and fair dispute resolution mechanisms to mitigate ethical dilemmas and protect creators' rights. Creators, in turn, must adhere to ethical standards, respect intellectual property rights, and engage in constructive dialogue with platforms to address concerns regarding copyright enforcement and false claims. Edward Lee notes a disconnect between legal standards and widely accepted social norms, creating diminished knowledge of copyright, as users view certain activities as socially acceptable even if they infringe copyright.²⁴

Issues with YouTube’s Accountability In False Copyright Infringement Claims

Cultural attitudes towards copyright, intellectual property, and content sharing vary globally, influencing legal interpretations and enforcement practices. International collaborations, adherence to international treaties such as WIPO guidelines, and culturally sensitive content governance approaches are essential. Balancing global perspectives with local cultural norms ensures inclusive and effective copyright enforcement strategies that resonate with diverse audiences and creators. Creators' narratives underscore the importance of platform accountability, community support, and legal protections in safeguarding their creative works and livelihoods. Insights from diverse creators across different content genres shed light on common challenges, best practices, and areas for improvement in copyright enforcement and ethical content practices.

²⁴ Lee.

Examining real-world experiences and insights from content creators provides valuable perspectives on the impact of false copyright claims and ethical considerations in digital content creation. Creators like DrKojoSarfo and John Swan have faced challenges related to false copyright claims and impartiality issues on platforms like YouTube, highlighting the need for fair and transparent copyright enforcement practices. YouTuber John Swan also received a copyright strike when he was critical of another creator in a video who subsequently made claims against it to silence him. Swan was told that YouTube's hands are tied when it comes to false claims because it has to balance the creator's interests and US Law. Swan commented that:

One of the main aspects of copyright law that allows YouTube to exist is Safe Harbor, where platforms like YouTube are not held responsible for copyrighted content uploaded by their users," he said. "If this law didn't exist, then platforms that host user content would not be able to exist."²⁵

But, because of this law, YouTube cannot step in and make decisions about these copyright claims because that would mean interpreting the law and ruling in favour of one party. That can only be done in a court of law. YouTube cannot take on the role of a courtroom, so they have to remain impartial since US Law says that DMCA Takedowns are to be resolved between the accused and the creator claiming their content was stolen.

Proposals for Protecting Social Media User's Rights

Practical strategies for protecting creator rights and ensuring fairness in digital content creation involve legal reforms, platform accountability, and user empowerment. Strengthening fair use provisions, enhancing transparency in copyright enforcement, and promoting dialogue between creators and platforms are critical steps toward addressing the challenges of false copyright claims. Ethical considerations enhance legal frameworks and practical strategies for addressing false copyright claims and promoting responsible digital content practices. Lauren Levinson discusses a joint proposal for fair

²⁵ Dodgson.

use in social media. The aim of this is to have best practices come into play on the internet and allow content creators, as copyright holders, to lessen any financial exploitation they may face while still allowing for noncommercial use of their content.²⁶

Collaborative efforts between stakeholders, including legal experts, content creators, advocacy groups, and platform representatives, will push for meaningful changes in copyright policies and enforcement mechanisms. Rather than creators being upset about remixes of their content gaining traction and income for another content creator, they should use the high amount of user traffic on said remix to collaborate with the other creator. Doing so allows both creators to gain monetary value from their joint video. However, a written agreement needs to be drawn up between both creators, where they communicate clearly about ownership and usage rights, avoiding misunderstandings now; whether or not both creators can bring in the same amount of income from the collaboration is not something they can control, as their accounts attract different audiences. With YouTube only allowing “the most popular of contributors to get paid through their advertising programs,”²⁷ there may need to be discussions of split earnings. However, it is doubtful that either collaborator would want to split their earnings evenly. As stated previously, capitalism is creating antagonism. Empowering creators with knowledge about their rights, fair use guidelines, and recourse options against false claims is essential in developing a more ethical and equitable digital content landscape. By embracing ethical content creation, transparent platform governance, informed audience engagement, and collaborative, ethical leadership, short-form platform stakeholders can navigate complexities and foster a more ethical and sustainable environment for their users. Moral awareness and proactive measures safeguard creators' rights, promote diverse expression, and enhance user trust and satisfaction in digital platforms.

²⁶ Levinson.

²⁷ Dalelio, 104.

Conclusion

In the intricate realm of digital platforms like TikTok and YouTube, a complex battle unfolds between content creators and the platforms themselves, with copyright chaos and ownership struggles at its core. YouTube's ongoing tussle with disputed claims underscores the challenges creators face in navigating fair use interpretations, sparking debates on intellectual property rights in the digital age. Approaching this research as a female graduate student at the University of Alberta, I maintained an unbiased perspective since I have no personal video creation experience on these platforms. Limited access to TikTok further ensured an outsider's viewpoint, although my Canadian background may influence certain aspects. With their convoluted Terms of Service and policies, platforms like TikTok favour themselves, leaving creators and remixers grappling for recognition and rights. This lopsided dynamic is made worse because "...as a user-generated content (UGC) medium, the platform's steady growth is rooted in the unpaid efforts of its users."²⁸

False copyright claims on platforms like YouTube pose significant ethical and legal challenges for content creators, especially those engaging in cross-platform content sharing such as TikTok Stitches and Duets. Users will need to champion their rights, whether that involves petitions to the social media moguls or federal courts. Balancing creator rights, fair use doctrines, and platform responsibilities requires collaborative efforts, transparent policies, and user education initiatives. Regarding platforms such as TikTok, which is made for creative participation, not just passive consumption, they are still private corporations looking out for themselves. Anyone sharing content must consider how their video will be received, shared, and reused. Moving beyond superficial consumer protections and addressing the core challenges creators face is imperative. Moving forward, prioritizing ethical content practices, strengthening fair use protections, and promoting platform accountability are essential steps in navigating the complexities of digital content creation while upholding intellectual property rights and fostering creativity. The world is far beyond the point of a need for simple protective measures for social media

²⁸ Facca et al.

creators and consumers. By prioritizing ethical content practices, bolstering fair use protections, and holding platforms accountable, content creators can strive for a balanced environment that respects everyone's rights in the digital realm.

Bibliography

Abramovitch, Susan, Madison MacColl, and Esther Kim. "TikTok: Time to Think About

Copyright." *Gowling WLG*, September 27, 2022.

<https://gowlingwlg.com/en/insights-resources/articles/2022/tiktok-time-to-think-about-copyright/>.

Burgess, John T. F. and Emily J. M. Knox. *Foundations of Information Ethics*. American Library Association, 2019.

"Community Guidelines strike basics on YouTube." YouTube Help. Accessed April 16, 2024.

<https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/2802032>.

Dalelio, Corinne M. *Interactive Media and Society*. Lexington Books, 2022.

"Defamation." Youtube Help. Accessed April 13, 2024.

https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/6154230?hl=en&ref_topic=6154211.

Dodgson, Lindsay. "YouTubers' Channels Are Being Held Hostage With Fake Copyright Claims." *Business Insider*. Last modified June 2, 2022.

<https://www.businessinsider.com/youtubers-channels-are-being-held-hostage-with-fake-copyright-claims-2020-6>.

Facca, Danica, Arun Jacob, J. P. King, Mujgan Ozceylan, and Sara Grimes. *Academic*

TikTok Report. Knowledge Media Design Institution (KMDI), August 2022.

https://tspace.library.utoronto.ca/bitstream/1807/124170/1/Academic_TikTok_Report_KMDI_2022.pdf.

Gallagher, Ryan J. "The Network Structure of Online Amplification." PhD dissertation, Northeastern University, August 9, 2022. <https://doi.org/10.17760/D20467308>.

"Information Ethics and Youtube Copyright Infringement System." The Information Age. Last modified on

October 14, 2017.

<https://katjameden.wordpress.com/2017/10/14/information-ethics-and-youtube-copyright-infringement-system/#more-126>.

Krahn, Jessie. "Here Comes the Author: Evolving Notions of Authorship on Social Media." Master's thesis, University of Manitoba, 2023.

<https://mspace.lib.umanitoba.ca/server/api/core/bitstreams/6dfcdc92-84d4-40be-b74d-ee998605cbe0/content>.

Kurschner, Tatiana. "Copyright Isn't for Everyone: Copyright Formalities as a Response to Authors' Needs in the Digital Age." Master's thesis, University of Oxford, 2021.

<https://ora.ox.ac.uk/objects/uuid:87e6333e-0a98-4438-bb12-1b78fa30ed0d>.

Lee, Edward. "Warming Up To User-Generated Content." *University Of Illinois Law Review* 2008, no. 5 (August 31, 2008): 1459-1548.

<https://illinoislawreview.org/print/volume-2008-issue-5/warming-up-to-user-generated-content/>.

Levinson, Lauren. "Adapting Fair Use to Reflect Social Media Norms: A Joint Proposal." *UCLA Law Review* 64, no. 4 (2017): 1038-1079.

<https://www.uclalawreview.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/09/Levinson-64-4.pdf>.

Reynolds, George W. *Ethics in Information Technology*. Cengage Learning Inc., 2019.

Severson, Richard J. *The Principles of Information Ethics*. M.E. Sharpe, 1997.

Smith, Sage. "Being conscientious when consuming and producing TikTok content." *Iowa State Daily*. March 10, 2020.

<https://iowastatedaily.com/240079/news/being-conscientious-when-consuming-and-producing-tiktok-content/>.

"Stitch." TikTok. Accessed April 13, 2024.

<https://support.tiktok.com/en/using-tiktok/creating-videos/stitch>.

"Submit a copyright removal request." YouTube Help. Accessed April 13, 2024.

<https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/2807622?hl=en>.

"Terms of Service." TikTok. Accessed April 13, 2024.

[https://www.tiktok.com/legal/page/row/terms-of-service/en.](https://www.tiktok.com/legal/page/row/terms-of-service/en)

"Terms of Service." YouTube. Accessed April 13, 2024.

[https://www.youtube.com/static?gl=CA&template=terms.](https://www.youtube.com/static?gl=CA&template=terms)